ADVENTURER GUIDE TO RELATIONSHIPS

Enhance romantic partnerships, friendships, and parent-child relationships

16Personalities

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Introduction

Why Relationships Matter to Adventurers

A person's personality traits influence every aspect of their life. When it comes to relationships, however, it's the interaction of two individuals' unique sets of traits and behaviors that takes center stage.

Relationships present Adventurers with wonderful opportunities to grow. In balanced relationships, Adventurers push for positive change, enabling each person to reach higher and do more than they could alone. In return, they'll often find themselves feeling more grounded.

Although they're Introverts, Adventurers often come across as charismatic and well connected. Perceptive and emotionally attuned, they bring their whole presence to interactions with other people. As a result, Adventurers rarely have difficulty connecting with others, whether they be new friends or potential partners. Even when these types are unpredictable or reckless, their charm easily disarms those around them. This is why, given their usual spontaneity and enthusiasm, Adventurers' periodic desire for "alone time" may surprise their friends and acquaintances. It contributes to the air of unpredictability and mystery that usually surrounds people with this personality type.

A common misconception about Adventurers is that they're endlessly easygoing. Beneath their relaxed exteriors, they're exquisitely sensitive to other people's feelings. They're inclined to seek harmony in all situations and have no difficulty sensing a change in others' emotional states. Due to this sensitivity, Adventurers can sometimes have unexpectedly strong reactions to criticism or even perceived criticism – a trait that can manifest itself with their partners, friends, and family.

Fortunately, Adventurers are flexible to the core, and they're more than capable of experimenting with new strategies and approaches to their relationships to ensure that they can create and maintain the enjoyable, lasting connections that make life all the more worth living. In these pages, we'll discuss how Adventurers can build the thriving, varied relationships that they crave. Along the way, we'll cover the strengths that people with this personality type bring to their romantic relationships, their friendships, and their roles as parents – as well as how they can deal with the interpersonal challenges that may threaten to get in their way.

Curious about the traits that make up your personality type and the theory behind them? You can learn more here.

Romantic Relationships

People with the Adventurer personality type are often a complete mystery to others, even surprising their long-term partners from time to time. Although they tend to be quite sensitive, emotional individuals, their vulnerability to criticism, conflict, and adversity results in their need to keep those traits well-hidden from the world. If their partners are willing to accept them for who they are, however, Adventurers also can be incredibly warm and enthusiastic.

Another defining Adventurer trait is an intense focus on the present. This makes for people who are very much "in the moment," but there are downsides to this. Adventurers don't always learn as much from their past romances as they could. In addition, their inability to tolerate discomfort in the present moment may lead to their bailing as soon as their relationships face challenges, stumbling blocks, or lulls. When it's time to change old patterns, negotiate tricky situations, and make long-term plans and commitments, some Adventurers are tempted to cut and run. From the outside, it looks as if they're utterly devoted one moment and then totally disconnected the next.

Adventurers face another major challenge in their relationships: feelings. The world of feelings can be gloriously all-consuming, from desire to joy to love itself, and people with this personality type tend to give themselves over to their emotions. At times, however, emotional regulation is necessary, whether it means taking a moment to cool down during an argument or considering criticism before defending against it. This skill doesn't come easily to Adventurers, and unless they

consciously develop it, they may overreact to criticism or snags in their relationships, taking every slight – real and imagined – personally.

When they bring these traits into balance, Adventurers are generous and enthusiastic lovers. Always seeking fresh ways to express their affection and enrich their relationships, they delight in making their partners feel special. For Adventurers, ideal romance is founded on true love, simple pleasures, and plenty of sparks.

Dating and Single Adventurers

Feelings and emotions underpin every aspect of the Adventurer personality, defining their relationships as well. These types are likely to be very caring, loyal individuals who are always looking for ways to surprise their sweethearts. Fortunately, this isn't a difficult task for Adventurers, thanks to their mix of practicality and spontaneity. They do tend to have relatively poor long-term planning skills, but they almost never run out of things to do in the present. This helps them bring freshness and unpredictability into their relationships.

Adventurers are realistic, well-grounded partners, willing to spend a lot of time and effort making sure that their significant others are cared for and feel special. People with this personality type have excellent listening skills and are, generally, very interested in knowing how their lovers feel. Logic, rationality, and strategic planning aren't their strongest suits, and most Adventurers are more than happy to let their partners take the lead in those areas. They're perfectly capable of holding up their ends of their relationships, though, especially when it comes to emotional matters.

Finally, it's important to note that people with the Adventurer personality type need to know that their love and attention are valued and appreciated. They're unlikely to ask for this validation, but they may feel frustrated and disappointed if their beloveds don't make efforts to express their feelings. Although this expression needn't be verbal – Adventurers believe in actions, not words – it's crucial that Adventurers know their partners reciprocate their feelings.

Adventurers in the Bedroom

From the sexual perspective, Adventurer personalities are likely to be very sensual and attentive. They love to engage all five senses and do

everything to make sure that their partners are fully satisfied as well. Even though Adventurers tend to be relatively reserved or even shy in social settings, these masks come off when they're with those they completely trust. When Adventurers reveal this rarely-seen side of their personality, their sweethearts are likely to be very pleasantly surprised.

As in other areas of their lives, Adventurers seek pleasure in the present moment, and they may feel less devoted to their partners if their sex lives plateau or fall into a rut. They may even be tempted to stray or end relationships if the spark fades. If the romance is meaningful, however, Adventurers are more than capable of reigniting the flame. They can use their creativity to look for new ways to please themselves and their partners, including introducing novelty, play, and experimentation into even the longest-standing of relationships.

Potential Personality Pairings

The Right Approach

Adventurers are typically affectionate and caring toward those they love. They know how to have a good time and delight in the moment, but they also contribute to their relationships in practical and consistent ways, proving to their beloveds that they're trustworthy and reliable. Despite their craving for novelty, Adventurers recognize when relationships are too precious to lose.

Romance is far from an exact science, and Adventurers intrinsically understand that putting their best foot forward achieves the best results. With so many personality variables in play, romance can highlight their strengths, including open-mindedness and adaptability. Relationships can also provide Adventurers with invaluable opportunities to learn and develop, growing into the individuals they want to see reflected in the eyes of their sweethearts.

The information presented in this section can help Adventurers build and navigate successful, loving relationships. With that in mind, we'll offer a useful look at some of the ways Adventurers and other types are likely to interact. Additionally, we'll help Adventurers to maximize their chances for happiness by providing tips for creating fulfilling, balanced relationships with those types.

Adventurer-Analyst Relationships

Adventurers decide matters through a more emotional filter; Analysts prefer a more rational one. The first is also more in touch with the concrete world, where the second dwells in a world of ideas and theories. In romance, opposites have been known to attract on occasion and, even more, to make their other halves more complete. That potential is there when Adventurers and Analysts fall in love. If they avoid making their differences points of contention, they're likely to find something unique and interesting with a kind of growth potential neither would experience alone.

Balanced Adventurer-Analyst Relationships

Open Minds, Good Times

In the early stages of their shared relationships, Adventurers might delight in the novelty of Analysts' ideas, particularly if these ideas relate to something tangible. Adventurers might also enjoy helping break Analyst sweethearts out of their serious, intellectual shells. With their carefree, inventive mindsets, these types find it gratifying to introduce Analysts to new ways of kicking back and having fun.

As these love affairs progress, Adventurers often appreciate Analysts' lack of concern about conventions and traditions. Adventurers love to try new things and embrace new trends, and they crave life partners who won't hold them back in their experimentation. Analysts typically are unconcerned with aesthetics, and they won't object when Adventurers break the mold—whether that means wearing wild new outfits or performing edgy songs during karaoke date nights.

Adventurers also appreciate the breathing room likely to be granted by Analyst partners. At times Analysts need to ruminate on their ideas and theories and go into their own mind palaces. Adventurers may not go along for the ride, but they can take advantage of these opportunities to discover more about the world in their particular way. Nobody can ever accuse an Adventurer-Analyst pair of smothering each other.

Unbalanced Adventurer-Analyst Relationships

Mirror, Mirror

In the dating process, some Adventurers might be turned off by Analysts. These types have a highly developed aesthetic sense, but when it becomes unbalanced, Adventurers veer into superficiality, becoming obsessed with image or appearances. These Adventurers may be embarrassed even to be seen with Analysts, who are hardly known for their sharp sense of style.

If Adventurers try to change Analysts – encouraging them to shop at cooler stores, for example – they're fighting a losing battle. Analysts have a good measure of self-respect, but they rarely see the point of trying to impress other people. They won't withhold their opinions, either, and Adventurers may find themselves being criticized for focusing on appearances rather than more "important" matters.

Criticism and Contempt

Lovers in Adventurer-Analyst relationships may not always appreciate how their differences can actually serve as strengths. As their romances progress, conversations may regularly spiral into criticism or even contempt. Adventurers may occasionally find themselves taken aback by Analysts' bluntness. In return, Adventurers might hurt their Analyst partners more than they realize.

Such conversations follow common patterns. Because Adventurers prefer to focus on actionable matters and the present moment rather than abstractions and hypothetical scenarios, their Analyst partners might accuse them of being shallow, unimaginative, or lacking in intellectual curiosity. Adventurers might also find themselves targeted

for their interest in "frivolous" matters, such as fun, fashion, or receiving attention from others.

This is a two-way street, however. Adventurers may lose patience with their Analyst sweethearts' need to theorize about everything, which to them may seem stodgy, boring, or pointless. Given Analysts' disregard for such nitty-gritty, practical matters, Adventurers may find – to their dismay – that household chores regularly fall to them. For both types, stress levels can escalate in tandem with their increasing domestic chaos, as laundry piles grow and dirty dishes overfill the sink.

Although Adventurers are generally good-natured, they readily externalize their feelings – including, at times, their negative judgments. Because Analysts less readily express their emotions, Adventurers might not even realize when they've hurt their beloveds' feelings. The result can cause pain and frustration on both sides, leaving Adventurers to wonder if it isn't time to move on.

Rebalancing Adventurer-Analyst Relationships

Inviting Analysts Along

Rather than becoming irritated at what they perceive as Analysts' stodginess, Adventurers can encourage Analyst partners to come along on one of their adventures. By inviting Analysts into their world of fun and discovery, Adventurers get a win-win: quality time with their significant others and the joy of sharing a good time.

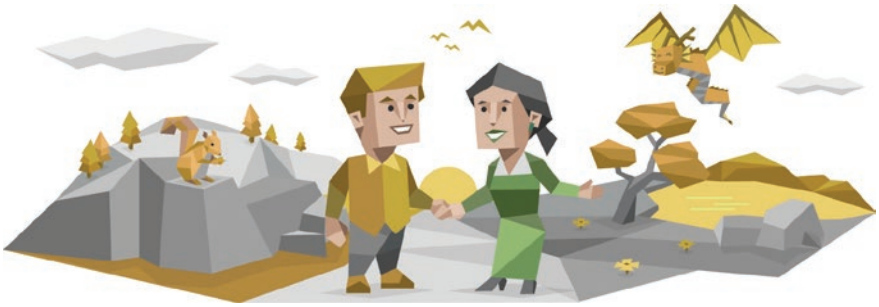
To persuade Analysts to participate in new activities, Adventurers can highlight the benefits or upsides of a particular adventure – whether that's taking advantage of a once-in-a-lifetime opportunity, seeing a new artist or band before they catch on, or just a stress-relieving hike and the resulting health benefits. Analysts think rationally, and they allocate their time and energy accordingly. Without losing their sense of spontaneity, Adventurers can focus just enough on the why of a particular activity to interest their Analyst partners.

Outsource, Automate, Skip

As relationships progress and couples move in together, they need to find sustainable ways to manage their shared homes. Because hands-on, mundane details are of less interest to Analysts, Adventurers may end up with more than their share of household responsibilities. As a result, Adventurers may feel bogged down by chores and duties that cramp their style – or they might be tempted to blow off these responsibilities, leaving their homes in a state of chaos. Although this might sound like a small matter, the division of domestic responsibilities can become a major issue in long-term relationships.

In this situation, Adventurers should sit down with their partners and – tedious though it may seem – write out a list of all recurring chores, payments, and tasks. Fortunately, the next step is much more fun: identify everything that can be outsourced, automated, or skipped altogether. This may mean budgeting for a cleaning service, setting aside some time to establish recurring bill payments, or even parting with rarely used items that require regular maintenance. By taking these steps, Adventurers and their Analyst partners can lighten their load of chores and responsibilities, leaving them more time and energy for pursuits that light them up instead.

Adventurer-Diplomat Relationships



While both base their decisions on humanistic, emotional foundations, Adventurers have a bias toward practical action, and Diplomats favor a less concrete approach. Diplomats might be at home reading books on ending poverty and dreaming of material equality in the world; Adventurers might just as likely be out pounding nails along with other volunteers with Habitat for Humanity. But romances between dreamers and doers are often successful. When they fall in love, they sometimes

find the dimensions their partners add are just what they needed in their lives.

Balanced Adventurer-Diplomat Relationships

Free Spirits

When they first date, Adventurers' free spirits and enthusiasm for living in the moment are enthralling for Diplomats. Given their curiosity about other people, Adventurers may be drawn to Diplomats' unusual ways of expressing themselves and their almost mystical presence. These two types tend to find a fair amount of shared ground, including mutual desires for freedom and novelty. As a result, when they begin dating, it can be a truly exciting time full of energy and anticipation.

As their relationships mature, Adventurers and Diplomats can bring out the best in each other. Neither is a slave to convention, so each is likely to grant the other the freedom to pursue unusual interests, seize new opportunities, and grow to their full potential. Adaptable and flexible, they can respond to unexpected challenges as a united front, weathering storms and embracing change when necessary. Over time, Adventurers may find that Diplomats deepen and enrich their lives, helping them to identify and embrace their values without losing their free-spirited spontaneity.

Unbalanced Adventurer-Diplomat Relationships

Drama Ensues

Adventurers live in the moment, expressing themselves and their feelings readily. This can be a wonderful match for Diplomats in the early stages of romance. As time progresses and the stakes get higher, however, Adventurers may inadvertently rile Diplomats' sensitivity. They're often surprised by the extent of Diplomats' inner landscapes, including the amount of time they spend dwelling on past issues and dreaming about the future. Unbeknownst to Adventurers, Diplomats might be engaging in such things as mulling over conversations from days before, putting their partners on a pedestal, or planning their future lives together.

When Adventurers levy criticism – even a mild one – it can suck the wind out of Diplomats' sails, particularly if it affects their visions of the future. Given their future orientation, Diplomats might assume that Adventurers are interested in pursuing long-term relationships when they're actually just enjoying the present moment. As a result, Diplomats' typical sensitivity can be heightened in arguments with their Adventurer sweethearts, creating a high level of drama. Such tension can cause Adventurers to act in unbalanced ways, such as leaving these issues unresolved, escaping conversations, or even bailing on relationships altogether.

Adventurer-Diplomat households might find themselves embroiled in drama for another reason as well: household chaos. Neither of these personality types is keen to commit to chore schedules or regular responsibilities. Although they might not seem like major issues, late bill payments and piles of mail can escalate the tension in any home.

I Love You, Now Change

Independent to the core, Adventurers dislike the idea of anyone trying to change them. In an unbalanced relationship, however, Diplomats – with their love of abstractions and possibilities – may try to turn Adventurers into theoretical, metaphysical thinkers. Over time, these Diplomats may grow tired of what they see as their Adventurer lovers' superficial need for novelty and good times.

Adventurers aren't always immune to the temptation to change their Diplomat partners, either. As their connections progress, they may become annoyed by Diplomats' tendency to live in their heads and dream about ways to help others instead of embracing experiences and taking practical action. Adventurers can also become frustrated when Diplomats – particularly Introverted types – need to stay home and relax rather than go out and have a good time. Unless they learn to appreciate the differences between themselves and their partners, Adventurers may abandon their Diplomat significant others in search of greener pastures.

Rebalancing Adventurer-Diplomat Relationships

Ease and Plenty

In the early stages of their love affairs, Adventurers and Diplomats can

thrive on each other's spontaneous energy and love of possibilities. As time progresses, however, these relationships – like all relationships – need solid, relatively predictable foundations. If they're constantly fretting about financial issues and car maintenance, these couples inevitably struggle to maintain their closeness and mutual respect.

As in relationships with Analysts, Adventurers should sit down with their Diplomat partners and make plans to handle recurring chores, payments, and tasks. Then, these two types can indulge their creative sides, identifying everything that can be outsourced, automated, or skipped altogether. Decluttering and donating unused items, and then arranging for a cleaning service once a week can go a long way toward making chores more equitable, and automatic bill pay apps can help take the guesswork out of handling household finances.

Over the long run, it's also important for Adventurers and Diplomats to face financial realities. Many of these can be automated or outsourced, as well, such as automatic contributions to retirement accounts or tax planning. By taking these steps, Adventurers and their Diplomat partners can spend more time and energy on their strengths, forging a strong connection rather than fretting over everyday matters.

Time Together, Time Apart

Adventurers and Diplomats might dive into romance headlong, wanting to spend great swathes of time with each other. As their partnerships progress, however, they need to set aside time to pursue their individual interests. Otherwise, Adventurers may exhaust their Diplomat partners with fun outings and events, leaving Diplomats insufficient time to tend to their ideas and dreams.

By balancing time together with time apart, these lovers can sidestep the need to change each other. Adventurers can venture to gallery openings, open mic nights, and parties to their hearts' delight, and Diplomats can nurture their Intuitive trait by reading, journaling, daydreaming, planning, or even setting up discussion groups or book clubs. Once they've satisfied these differing needs, Adventurers and Diplomats can focus on spending quality time together, doing mutually enjoyable activities.

Adventurer-Sentinel Relationships

While Adventurers and Sentinels might share many of the same preferences, their contrasting Prospecting and Judging traits make all the difference. Like the rudder on a ship decides its direction, these opposing characteristics tend to turn Sentinels right and Adventurers left.

However, both these types enjoy the practicality that comes with living in the "real world." Adventurer-Sentinel couples don't have to put up with all the theories and abstractions they might with Analysts or Diplomats. Each likes to live practical lives where they manipulate material things. In sharing this focus, these sweethearts speak the same down-to-earth language.

Balanced Adventurer-Sentinel Relationships

Practical Action

When Adventurers and Sentinels date, they discover a mutual love of quick, practical action. Thanks to their shared Observant trait, both types live firmly in the "here and now," focusing on life as it is, rather than life as it could be. They don't have to put up with all the theories and abstractions that they might with Analysts or Diplomats.

Over time, Adventurers and Sentinels can become deeply attuned to each other. This can manifest itself even in the ways they communicate. Their conversations often center on specific, actionable issues – not the future-oriented vagaries that those with the Intuitive trait would favor. As a result, Adventurer-Sentinel couples can operate as effective teams, solving problems and facing challenges in real time.

Novelty and Security

Adventurer-Sentinel couples can complement each other in balanced ways, providing a perfect yin to the other's yang. This might surprise some people, given Adventurers' love of novelty and Sentinels' love of security. It's true that Adventurers have a reputation for commitment-phobia, but, fortunately, they're unlikely to gravitate toward Sentinels until they're mature and see the value of settling down.

During long-term relationships with Sentinels, Adventurers find support, care, and consistency – three things they may not even realize they crave. Many Adventurers aren't recognized as bright or gifted as children, and devoted Sentinels can help them restore their sense of self-worth. Meanwhile, Adventurers get a kick out of exposing Sentinels to new things. After all, even Sentinels crave a little excitement in their lives, as long as it's not too disruptive.

Unbalanced Adventurer-Sentinel Relationships

Repetitive Roles

In the early stages of their shared romance, Adventurers may be fascinated by the differences between themselves and their Sentinel partners. Over time, however, Sentinel-Adventurer couples can fall into unbalanced roles that mimic a parent and a child, with Sentinels managing all the responsibilities and Adventurers initiating all the fun. At first, Adventurers may not mind this arrangement, but this dynamic prevents them from developing into their full potential – and can spark frustration and resentment in their Sentinel partners. If these relationships progress too far in this direction, it may seem as if Sentinels are smothering, controlling, or even infantilizing their Adventurer lovers.

When Adventurers feel that "smother-love," they often back away from the relationship. This can trigger Sentinels, who crave stability and commitment, to attempt to regain control. Sentinels may respond to this by redoubling their caretaking efforts, making Adventurers feel even more trapped. The result is tumultuous, unhappy relationships where neither type feels free to be themselves.

Commitment Mismatch

It's no secret that Adventurers tend to be less keen on commitment than Sentinels. As we've established, Adventurers might not even consider Sentinel partners until they feel ready to settle into long-term relationships. That said, Sentinels make up a sizable portion of the population, so statistically, Adventurers are likely to encounter them in the dating pool.

In Adventurer-Sentinel relationships that lose balance, Adventurers might feel as if their sweethearts are pushing them to make commitments or major decisions – such as defining their relationships or moving in together – before they feel ready. They may also perceive their Sentinel partners as needy or clingy. Meanwhile, Adventurers might struggle to understand or validate their Sentinel partners' natural need for commitment and stability.

Even in other areas of their love affairs, this disjointedness between Adventurers' Prospecting trait and Sentinels' Judging trait can create tension. Adventurers' spontaneity and changeability can cause stress for their Sentinel partners, who rely on tradition and predictability in order to feel grounded. Adventurers might not understand why their partners become anxious about trying new restaurants or changing travel plans at the last minute. Over time, Sentinels' resistance to change can wear on Adventurers, leading to their looking for escape routes.

Rebalancing Adventurer-Sentinel Relationships

Appreciation and Affirmation

In relationships with Sentinels – or any personality type, for that matter – it's important for Adventurers to stay true to themselves. When they feel trapped or stifled, they may indulge their instinct to move on and seek new relationships. That said, even if Adventurers aren't ready to commit to major transitions like marriage, they can still offer their partners reassurance and support. This is especially important with Sentinel partners, who, although they don't generally ask for it, thrive on recognition and praise.

Adventurers can set themselves the goal of expressing appreciation for their Sentinel partners on a daily basis. This can take the form of verbal thank-yous and compliments, but it doesn't have to – Adventurers' concrete, spontaneous natures can be an asset here. They can stay on the lookout for creative ways to validate and appreciate their partners, whether writing songs for them or treating them to date nights they'll love. When Sentinels receive this type of consistent affirmation, they can relax, making them less likely to control or smother their Adventurer beloveds.

R-E-S-P-E-C-T

In unbalanced Adventurer-Sentinel relationships, Sentinels end up taking on nearly all of the household responsibilities. Unbeknownst to Adventurers, these Sentinels may also keep score in their minds, noting all the ways they do more than their partners to keep things running smoothly. The result, unfortunately, is resentment and contempt – not exactly the ingredients for romance.

The solution to this situation is respect: both self-respect and respect for their partners. Adventurers do best when they notice the scales of responsibility are tilted too far in their partners' direction. In this situation, Adventurers recognize that they're capable of helping out more – a hallmark of self-respect. They then respectfully ask their partners how they can better help out. Adventurers can ask targeted, concrete questions such as:

- What tasks do you find the most burdensome?
- I have a free hour, so what can I tackle to allow you some time to do what you want?
- Are there any chores or errands that we can do together?

In balanced long-term relationships, both types make consistent contributions, demonstrating their care by sharing necessary responsibilities.

Adventurer-Explorer Relationships

Someone to explore with – at least, that's what one might assume is the draw when Adventurers fall in love with other Explorers. But even such a match made in heaven can have nooks and crannies that make them less than perfect under the right circumstances. The Observant and Prospecting combination produces much energy and movement and, when multiplied in such couples, can be exciting. But doubling this characteristic in romantic relationships can also be a drain and subject these partners to unstable impulsivity. Both types may need to understand what commitment means to them and be honest with each other.

Balanced Adventurer-Explorer Relationships

Smooth Sailing

Old saws would have us believe that "opposites attract," as though the human heart were the pole of a magnet. Fortunately, no two people are exactly alike, even if they share the same basic personality traits. There are adaptations and nuances that prevent relationships between two Explorers from being the same as looking into a mirror. There can be plenty of the differences that keep romance interesting even between couples of the same type.

In the early stages of their relationships, Adventurers may be exhilarated to be with lovers who share their craving for novelty. When Adventurers and other Explorers come together romantically, their emphasis is on playful, exciting experiences. Spending time together, they may feel even more alive than usual, creating a flirtatious, vibrant, almost electric energy between them. Because they often share similar views on commitment, these two types can enjoy the moment fully without having mismatched expectations about the future.

As these relationships progress, such couples can maintain flexibility not seen among any other paired types. Their partnerships are founded on the "here and now," and any storms between them tend to pass quickly. Balanced Adventurer-Explorer couples sometimes engage in heated exchanges, but they don't hold grudges, and they aren't overly sensitive to criticism. As a result, their occasional arguments don't compromise the foundation of their relationships. There's typically a certain resilience with these couples who live lives that allow for a certain amount of flux.

Big Moves, Lasting Adventures

In the early stages of Adventurer-Explorer relationships, each may orchestrate large romantic gestures and "wow" their partners. When the mood strikes them, they go big: skywriting, lavish gifts, impromptu vacations, and so on. As their relationships progress, these impulses might become less frequent, but balanced Adventurer-Explorer couples still try at times to sweep each other off their feet.

Even as their shared relationships mature, there are plenty of opportunities for these couples to share novel experiences. To stay connected, Adventurers and their Explorer partners can pursue common interests in arts, crafts, and even business. They can also integrate and expand their social circles in harmony, enjoying contact with all sorts of interesting people. In balanced Adventurer-Explorer love affairs, these couples continue to embark on shared journeys even as the decades tick by. Such bonding of interests can provide creative stimulation and strong partnerships that last lifetimes.

Unbalanced Adventurer-Explorer Relationships

Conquests and Capriciousness

Explorers are perhaps the most mercurial types when it comes to romance. They may play the field as long as they can, resisting being "tied down" in favor of the chase. Both Adventurers and other Explorers often bounce from partner to partner, looking for fulfillment in novelty and new conquests. They leave unfinished business in their wake, sometimes breaking off relationships without even trying to explain why.

At some point, usually with age, many Explorers decide to settle down. However, they don't always date with such long-term plans in mind. Their decision to commit may be spontaneous and almost impulsive. When couples include not one but two Explorers, it's easy to see how their romance can be intense and unpredictable. These partners might enter their relationships with the intent to live in the moment and see where it goes, but if one type becomes attached and craves more of a commitment, they may end up deeply hurt or disappointed.

Burnout

In the early stages of dating, Adventurer-Explorer couples might feel giddy about all the things they can experience together: travel, adventure, sports, parties, art exhibits, restaurants, bars, and so on. Alas, even the most energetic Explorers can only bear such intensity for so long before it becomes too much.

Over time, Adventurer-Explorer couples may tire of expending so much energy and experiencing so much excitement. They might not realize this is the issue, however. Instead, they might attribute their feelings of burnout to their romance, concluding that their partners are responsible for their loss of enthusiasm and joie de vivre.

Rebalancing Adventurer-Explorer Relationships

Downtime and Stability

Although it runs counter to their natures, Adventurer-Explorer couples experiencing burnout need to cultivate stability and downtime in their lives. To do this, they can minimize needless stress by automating and outsourcing routine tasks and responsibilities. They might also plan to spend time at home on a regular basis – for example, cozy "Netflix-and-chill" nights once or twice a week. By dedicating time to recharging their figurative batteries together, they can experience their relationships without distractions and stimuli from the outside world. They might even sweeten these evenings at home by establishing some quiet traditions, such as cooking new dishes together.

It's also important for these couples to give each other some space. It's perfectly fine if Adventurers want to go to an art opening and their

Explorer sweethearts want to have dinner with friends. As long as they still nurture their shared interests and embark on adventures together, Adventurer-Explorer relationships may actually be strengthened by occasional time apart.

Remembering Why They Fell in Love

The honeymoon phase of romantic relationships may be sweet, but it isn't sustainable. Over time, even devoted couples can feel restless. Adventurers may be tempted to give up on relationships almost on a whim, to the extent that they lose sight of what drew them to their partners in the first place.

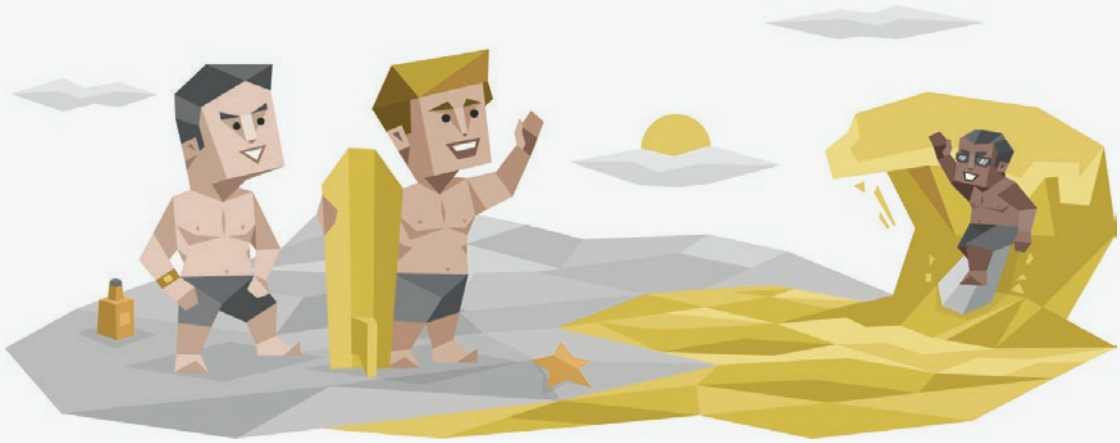
In this situation, it's helpful for Adventurers to remember why they fell in love. Before giving up on their relationships, they might want to sit down and list all the qualities that initially appealed to them about their significant others. These should be qualities that their partners still embody – for example, their intelligence, their honesty, or their wit.

Adventurers who truly struggle to remember their lovers' good qualities might try looking through old photos, recalling the details of their first dates, or even chatting with a few friends to see what they remember. After drawing up such lists, Adventurers might be moved by how many strengths and gifts their partners bring to their lives. If they'd like, Adventurers can share their lists with their partners, but it's fine for them to keep them as private reminders of why they fell in love.

Conclusion

It's not unusual for people with this personality type to feel tempted to bounce from option to option, but love provides powerful motivation to explore the full range of life with another person. While it's not likely to happen overnight, Adventurers are fully capable of balancing their desire for novelty with the demands of a shared relationship, appreciating the inspiration and guidance that they can gain from a partner they love and trust. A dedicated life partner not only brightens Adventurers' days but also offers them wellsprings of care and support.

When romance is founded on acceptance, honesty, and respect, there's no reason why Adventurers cannot enjoy lasting and balanced love with any personality type.



Friendships

Easygoing and Spontaneous Friends

When it comes to friendship, Adventurers are some of the most comfortable people around. Laid back and spontaneous, people with the Adventurer personality type don't bog things down with arguments or structured long-term plans. Intellectually exhausting pastimes like debates over European economic policy don't tend to hold their attention long. The here and now is what's important to Adventurers, and they love spending time with their friends engaging in casual, fun activities.

Adventurers believe in action, not words. They talk about what "is," not what "could," "should," or "will be," and then they do it. This passion for action is a blessing for these types since it helps them get past their shyness in meeting new people. They're sensitive – much more so than most – and it takes time for them to build enough trust with new friends to open up and feel natural.

People with this personality type are happy to get along with just about anyone, but potential friends must ease up on being too judgmental or demanding. If new acquaintances start things out by explaining, "You'd do way better if..." it's unlikely they'll ever be close – Adventurers just take these remarks too personally.

If their friends keep things supportive and easygoing, Adventurers are happy to return the favor with added warmth and laughter. When they're with friends they trust, Adventurers know how to relax, shedding rules, traditions, and expectations and just enjoy themselves.

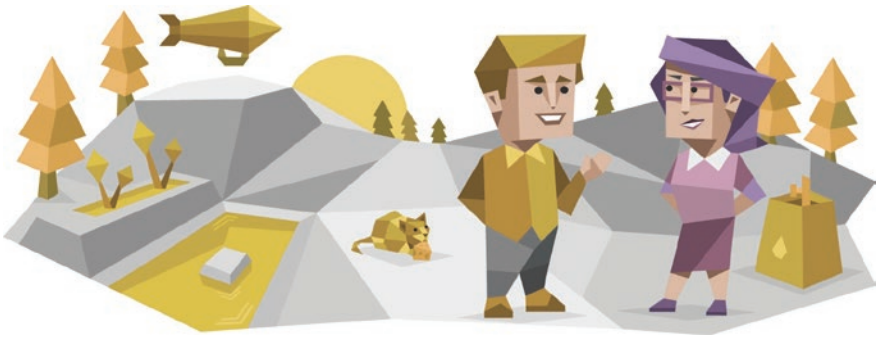
Adventurers' relaxed, non-judgmental attitudes make it easy for them to get along with others, but it's not always the same way around. Those types who prefer safe, structured environments might struggle in such friendships, especially if they lecture Adventurers on how they're living their lives. As with any criticism, Adventurers feel such judgmental friends can do their own thing and should leave Adventurers to do theirs.

Adventurers and Friends of Other Types

Adventurers are popular, as their open-mindedness, interesting hobbies, and relaxed attitude are attractive to a remarkably broad range of personality types. With so many acquaintances, Adventurers are sure to strike up deeper friendships with at least a few.

Let's examine the challenges and joys that Adventurers are likely to face in friendships with other people belonging to each of the major Roles – Analysts, Diplomats, Sentinels, and Explorers. We'll look at some ways Adventurers can balance their style to make their friendships more valuable, fair, and fulfilling.

Adventurer-Analyst Friendships



Friends who bring different perspectives to the table are sometimes the best friends to have. When Adventurers (Observant and Feeling) befriend Analysts (Intuitive and Thinking), the balance and counterbalance within their relationships can be sublime. Adventurers bring spontaneity and passion, while Analysts offer ideas and insights, both potentially contributing to rich, multidimensional friendships.

Balanced Adventurer-Analyst Friendships

Combining Strategy and Action

The best thing about having Analyst friends is that they're able to act as rational, insightful, and strategically-minded advisors for highly practical (and sometimes impatient) Adventurers. Analysts pride themselves in being objective, even with their closest friends. Companions belonging to this type group are likely to have few qualms about criticizing Adventurers' latest ideas or specific actions. Being direct themselves, Adventurers tend to feel right at home when it comes to such an approach – if the criticism isn't too harsh or personal. Analysts' penchant for conceptual thinking may frustrate Adventurers, but having such friends who are able and willing to look at things from different viewpoints can be invaluable in many situations.

Adventurers and Analysts also share a desire for efficiency. If the topic is right, otherwise-aloof Adventurers may spend hours tinkering with systems or polishing their techniques. With Analysts trying to understand the principles behind the functionality, and Adventurers experimenting with what's in front of them, such partnerships can be mutually rewarding. Their principles and perspectives may not necessarily overlap, but there should be enough common ground for both types to benefit from opportunities to share their thoughts with each other.

Unbalanced Adventurer-Analyst Friendships

Tangible versus Conceptual

Adventurers and Analysts also have their fair share of differences that may cause tension in their mutual friendships. The most important difference is the way these types take in information. Adventurers are highly practical, live-in-the-moment individuals – as far as they're concerned, it's the real, tangible things that matter most. Analysts mostly focus on what they can imagine and deduce, taking pleasure in coming up with various concepts and ideas. While there are ways to combine the two approaches (for instance, while working on projects requiring both planning and execution), these two dissimilar thinking styles can be major barriers to communication and mutual understanding.

Another important difference is that, unlike Adventurers, Analyst types usually find it difficult to support their friends emotionally. Analysts can have very strong feelings, but they're neither comfortable with nor experienced in coping with the emotions of others. Adventurers enjoy sharing their feelings with friends and developing strong support networks, so they can be surprised when their Analyst friends find it difficult to develop similar emotional connections. Adventurers shouldn't take this personally, as Analysts are notorious for their focus on logic and rationality, regardless of whose company they're in.

Rebalancing Adventurer-Analyst Friendships

Focusing on Common Ground

While these types may have drastically different ways of exploring, expressing creativity, and thinking about the future, they can rely on their common pragmatism to resolve any differences within their friendships. One very strong trait Analysts and Adventurers share is their appreciation of effectiveness – they both love to see practical solutions in place and functioning. This shared appreciation isn't limited to technical areas but also applies to the social realm. For both types, particularly in matters of pure preference (where to eat, for example), it's only rational to conclude that occasional compromise might be in order. Why? Because friends are worth it.

When these types experience more serious friction with each other, both can dial down their frustrated sense of superiority and instead focus on finding practical solutions together. Resolving their differing methods and preferences can be as easy as each opening their minds to see the merits of another perspective and trying it. Likewise, instead of just arguing for their own way, these friends can respect each other's approaches enough to justify their arguments with some facts. Telling friends they're wrong about something only carries hurtful judgement, but showing them better ways that work is a respectful form of disagreement that both these types can handle.

Adventurer-Diplomat Friendships

When Adventurers befriend Diplomats, there's likely to be a warmth that stems from their shared focus on more humanistic interests. Both are passionate in their own ways, with Adventurers preferring hands-on expressions of their enthusiasms and Diplomats favoring ideas and dreams. If they choose to become friends, they're likely to already see the value of each other's style and that their differences can be assets rather than liabilities to their bonds.

Balanced Adventurer-Diplomat Friendships

An Exciting and Inspiring Pair

For Adventurers, having close Diplomat friends can be both a very rewarding and very perplexing experience. While both types are likely to share excitement about discovering and experiencing new things (although their definitions of what makes something interesting are likely to be very different), they may also remain enigmas to each other for a long time. This is probably the most challenging personality combination of all – and for several reasons.

Diplomats are enthusiastic, passionate, and imaginative individuals. Their energy is likely to be inspiring to Adventurers, at least initially, perhaps even making them think their friends are similar to them. Diplomats are rare compared to other personality types, and Adventurers may find their unusual thinking very intriguing. This passionate pairing can create the ideal combination of ideas and action – if they're on the same page.

Unbalanced Adventurer-Diplomat Friendships

Neglecting the Necessities

One issue Adventurers and their Diplomat friends may come across is their shared tendency to neglect day-to-day matters and necessities. Whether it's Adventurers going on unplanned road trips a week before their tax returns are due, or Diplomats forgetting to transfer their rent money amid their volunteering activities, both types may sometimes deal with unpleasant surprises – especially if those matters affect their shared friendship. Routine isn't these free-spirits' strong suit, and both Adventurers and their Diplomat friends must pay attention to their mutual responsibilities.

Additionally, Diplomats primarily live in their minds, and this behavior can be quite foreign to practical-minded Adventurers. Diplomats' nearly constant soul-searching is as meaningful to them as experiencing things is to Adventurers. From self-help books to seeking personal enlightenment, Diplomats are almost always pursuing self-improvement. Adventurers, meanwhile, are more focused on appreciating who they are and playing up their personal strengths. Their Diplomat friends' focus on self-improvement can eventually wear on them and may come across as impractical (and, at worst, completely self-absorbed.)

Rebalancing Adventurer-Diplomat Friendships

Regardless of these issues, Adventurer-Diplomat friendships can be fulfilling and inspiring. Empathic, insightful Diplomats can easily draw more reserved Adventurers out of their shells, encouraging them to share their thoughts and ideas. Diplomats tend to have a knack for making people feel relaxed and comfortable, and restless Adventurers can benefit from such company. On the other side of the fence, idealistic and often absent-minded Diplomats may find it helpful to spend time with highly practical, efficiency-oriented Adventurers. As rewarding as brainstorming can be, often there's just no substitute for some good, real-world fun.

Adventurers typically desire deep connections with others. Despite their need for independence, they appreciate interacting with others in meaningful ways. Thanks to their empathetic natures, Diplomats can not only understand their Adventurer friends' need for freedom but can be supportive of it.

Adventurer-Sentinel Friendships

Glancing at the personality type letters, Adventurers and Sentinels may look very similar, but what a difference a single letter can make. Where Adventurers are spontaneous, Sentinels foster stability. Where Adventurers are pragmatists who aren't always concerned with the rules, Sentinels uphold every iota of established standards. These differences, however pronounced, don't necessarily make friendship between the two types impossible. There's actually much potential when these opposites attract.

Balanced Adventurer-Sentinel Friendships

Providing Practical Support

Sentinels are numerous and are likely to form a significant part of Adventurers' social circles. These personality types are likely to be loyal, practical, and down-to-earth friends, always eager to offer advice and support. Sentinel friends can help Adventurers stay focused and realistic when it's necessary – for instance, when Adventurers get so caught up in pursuing their hobbies and pet projects they forget to attend to daily matters or obligations. Sentinels' patience, stability, and sense of loyalty can be invaluable when their Adventurer pals feel confused or uncertain about their chosen paths.

Both Adventurers and Sentinels tend to be highly practical with their feet planted firmly on the ground. These friends are likely to focus on activities that engage their senses, such as participating in sports, going on hikes, or working on something tangible together. More adventurous and spontaneous Adventurers may convince their Sentinel friends to let go of their serious, composed attitude and simply have fun occasionally. Similarly, the structured and orderly style embraced by Sentinels can counterbalance Adventurers' occasional devil-may-care approach.

Unbalanced Adventurer-Sentinel Friendships

Freewheeling versus Stability-Seeking

The main point of contention in Adventurer-Sentinel friendships is likely to be their different definitions of freedom and individualism. Adventurers are famous for their unyielding, independent spirit, seeing many rules and traditions as stifling and redundant limitations. To them, freedom of expression overrides social cohesion or security every time.

Sentinels scoff at those who think about ignoring social conventions for the sake of individualism. From their perspective, stability and security are topmost concerns, and they're likely to argue that the needs of the many outweigh those of the few. These differences may lead to some heated discussions revolving around flexibility and responsibility, with each personality type sticking to their guns.

Rebalancing Adventurer-Sentinel Friendships

Appreciating Alternative Points of View

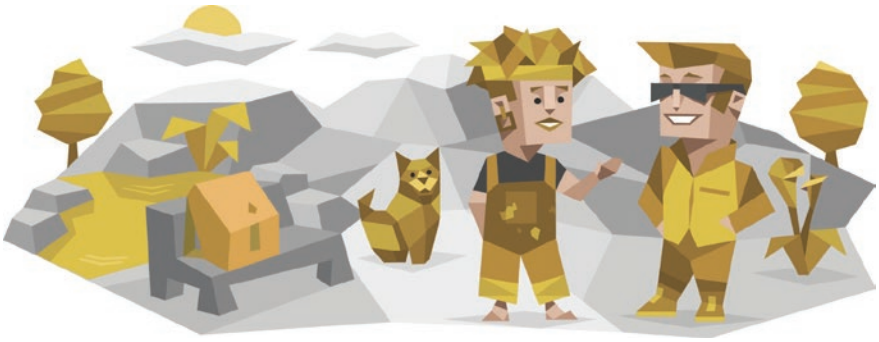
There's little these types can do to rebalance friction in their friendships unless they're willing to acknowledge the virtues of each other's perspective. This doesn't mean they must adopt those viewpoints as their own, but recognizing that different lifestyles can work for different people give these two types a chance to bridge their differences.

Adventurers can appreciate how Sentinels enjoy the sense of security that low-risk stability brings, and respect that what may seem like short-term limits or restrictions may create lasting long-term success.

Sentinels can appreciate that while a spontaneous, risk-taking approach may not be for them, Adventurers can – and do – make it work in their own lives. In true friendships, seeing comrades happy and successful is more important than being right. Sentinels can gaze at their Adventurer friends with supportive amazement instead of dismay, knowing that, win or lose, they're likely to pick themselves up and begin anew.

These friends can also accept input from each other, as each may be accomplished in their own ways, and equally capable of giving each other some balance. Sentinels who learn to take measured risks by following in their Adventurer friends' wake can undoubtedly increase their opportunities in life, and Adventurers who listen to the wise advice of Sentinel friends may sidestep some of their own worst mistakes.

Adventurer-Explorer Friendships



"Live for the moment" could be the motto for Adventurers who strike up friendships with other Explorers. The exhilaration of such spontaneous and active relationships is likely to be heady for both since they're asked to conform and downshift in so many other facets of their lives. However, there is no such thing as a perfect friendship and even this seemingly seamless match has hazards to avoid – mostly because there can be too much of a good thing.

Balanced Adventurer-Explorer Friendships

Lively and Low-Stress Companions

For Adventurers, having close Explorer friends is like looking into a mirror. Explorers tend to be practical, inventive individuals, so it's very unlikely that such friends would ever run out of things to do. Explorers

prefer to bond over shared activities, so such friends tend to find it easy to maintain camaraderie regardless of difficulties, often pushing each other to explore new hobbies or put more efforts into existing ones.

Lots of personal space and freedom are essential to Adventurer personalities, and its usually other Explorer types – who share their "live and let live" worldview and joy in doing things – that gravitate toward Adventurers. When spending time together, these types find it easy to drop their pretenses and enjoy low-stress fun.

Unbalanced Adventurer-Explorer Friendships

Unchecked Risk-Takers

The key challenge for Adventurer-Explorer friends is likely to come from the same source that fuels their relationship – their similarity. Having friends who think in similar ways can be fun and reassuring, but it can also put these types in a bubble, isolating them from criticism and different opinions. There's a risk that Adventurers may convince Explorer friends that their behavior and attitude are fine, even when some obvious issues need to be addressed – such as dealing with mundane yet necessary tasks – and vice-versa.

Another issue that Adventurers and their Explorer friends may face is that they're likely to place more importance on practical and tangible things than imagination and mental exercises. It may be a good idea for both types to encourage each other to remember that finding time for intellectual growth and discussions about the past or the future can also be very beneficial. While Adventurers and their Explorer friends tend to mostly enjoy living in the moment, it's also important to stop and think about the big picture occasionally.

Rebalancing Adventurer-Explorer Friendships

Practicing Interaction and Accountability

Regardless of these hiccups, Adventurers and their Explorer friends tend to feel as if they've found their true mind mates. Their shared spontaneity, boldness, and willingness to push limits make them fun and interesting

friends and give them plenty of opportunities to bond. The main challenge for Adventurers, however, is often finding other Explorers (especially with similar hobbies), not keeping such friendships alive.

Clubs, sports teams, and art classes are just a few locations where Adventurers can find fellow Explorers to befriend. While it may seem intimidating at first to these Introverted types, something as simple as striking up a conversation with someone at the gym can lead to future friendship. Adventurers can make a goal of chatting with one new person per week and may discover it not only becomes easier to interact with unfamiliar people, but they'll likely find friends that share common interests.

Finally, Adventurers and their Explorer companions are likely to benefit from a healthy dose of risk analysis occasionally. While their shared boldness may be one of their greatest traits, the resulting risky behaviors can have negative side effects. From ill-advised impulse purchases to reckless one-night stands, the consequences of their spontaneity can have severe and lasting repercussions. Fortunately, Adventurers and their Explorer friends can learn to temper these behaviors and commit to holding each other accountable. Often such "accountability buddies" are the most effective in helping to prevent poor choices, and committing to this process with Explorer pals can bring balance to Adventurers' lives and deepen their friendships.

Conclusion

Adventurers are often quiet types, Introverts who carefully select their friends and usually greatly value them as a rare commodity. Their bias toward action is likely to bring an extra measure of energy into the lives of those they befriend, and their practicality may broaden or shift their friends' perspectives. Friendship with unique Adventurers is likely something to treasure.

Adventurers who try to develop friendships are likely to be more anchored and balanced because of those relationships. If they find someone who shares their interest, a partner in crime to bounce ideas and schemes off of is likely to be prized. They may have to give up some of the independence that they hold so dear, but the trade-off may be well worth it.

Parenthood

Balanced Adventurer Parenthood

Warm and Practical

When it comes to parenting, Adventurers often feel right at home. Parenthood is a task for which no one is prepared, but individuals with the Adventurer personality type have a natural warmth, practicality, and relaxed nature that help them to settle in and appreciate every moment of joy and hardship that comes with raising a child.

The delight Adventurers' receive from being with and helping loved ones is arguably their greatest strength. Children of Adventurer parents have all their practical needs taken care of from day one and can always count on something exciting to do or learn every day. People with the Adventurer personality type love fun, hands-on activities, and as their children grow, they're often encouraged to pick up extra hobbies that revolve around those kinds of events.

Even as those extra activities increase, Adventurers are able to balance their Introversion and spend time with their children engaging in enjoyable activities that center on quality time. Impromptu trips, home improvement projects like repainting bedrooms, or simply baking treats together are all likely to become fond memories for Adventurers' sons and daughters.

This doesn't mean Adventurer parents are overbearing – in fact, they're one of the most relaxed personality types there is when it comes to parenting. They believe the only way to really have their children grow

up to be open-minded and well-balanced people is to let them explore and experience new things, make mistakes and learn from them, and to always know that they'll be able to come home at the end of it. Interventions and hardline rules just aren't Adventurers' style.

Unbalanced Adventurer Parenthood

Struggling with Structure and Criticism

The freedom Adventurers grant their children comes with risks, too, because it demands a certain level of maturity from the children themselves. Some lessons are harder than others. This can prove difficult for parents with the Adventurer personality type because they're more sensitive than most when it comes to facing criticism about their lifestyles or parenting. For them, nothing's quite as unpleasant as, "I told you so."

Long-term planning is another challenging area for Adventurer parents, especially those with an unbalanced preference for spontaneity over any form of structure. When it comes to things like saving for their kids' college education, Adventurers may need to rely on partners who take care of that sort of thing more readily.

Adventurers sometimes struggle as well as their children grow into adolescence. These parents need to know their work and effort are appreciated, something teenagers aren't well-known for expressing. It can take a lot of practice on the part of Adventurer parents to learn the emotional control necessary to not overreact when things don't go the way they want. Children try to distance themselves at that age, and, private individuals or not, Adventurers need to know that those they love are by their sides during their kids' trying teen years.

Rebalancing Adventurer Parenthood

Providing Structure and Support

Although it may not come naturally, Adventurers need to find a way to provide some sort of structure – which includes discipline – for their children. By using the warmth and practicality that does come naturally

to them, they can provide the loving support that their daughters and sons need while also communicating the necessity of the rules they're enforcing.

Discipline is a tricky topic for all parents, especially those who always want to feel "liked," but their kids are more likely to both like and respect them in the long run if they provide the necessary boundaries. It may seem like they're doing their teenagers a favor by not enforcing their curfews, but they're actually doing their teens a disservice by setting up unrealistic expectations about how rules actually work. It's important for Adventurer parents to remember that fun can be had (and is often more rewarding for both themselves and their children) within consistent, loving boundaries they enforce.

Ultimately, Adventurers are much less likely to create the kinds of divides that other more rigid personality types sometimes drive between themselves and their children. There's always going to be some push from developing adults, but with such warm, caring parents, Adventurers' children can always rest assured that they know where home and hearth are.

Parent-Child Type Combinations

Talking about personality types and children is always an interesting proposition. While most see personality as something that's at least partly genetic and inherent, those influences may only lightly touch little ones or only be vaguely apparent during their development. Childhood is about experimenting, learning, and adapting. This means their behavior is often exploratory rather than permanently defining. There may be hints of a personality type, but with so much adapting going on, it may be hard to pinpoint their consistent traits exactly. Since children aren't self-aware enough to take a personality test, they don't have the same advantages as adults who can answer questions describing their preferences.

Therefore, when we talk about the Analyst child, for example, we are referring mainly to children who may show a preference for a rational approach – even if it's sporadic. But we urge caution toward labeling children until they're older and can tell us their preferences themselves.

Childhood is all about discovery, and we advocate giving them a chance to do that on their own and in their own time without the confines of labels.

Nonetheless, for the sake of discussion, we'll describe things that Adventurers may want to notice when parenting children who engage in certain trait behaviors – whether those behaviors are a phase or prove to be more consistent over time.

Adventurer Parent and an Analyst Child

A Curious and Open-Minded Duo

Analyst children are likely to be intellectually-minded, curious, and very imaginative. Their creativity and tolerance tend to delight their Adventurer parents, as their kids' willingness to explore the unknown intrigues them and any similarities to their own penchant for improvisation is a pleasure to discover.

Adventurers and Analysts share an interest in finding out how things work, which is why it's unlikely that Adventurer parents have major difficulties communicating with their children or coming up with interesting activities. Furthermore, Analyst children tend to be focused and driven once they find something that interests them. Adventurers share this trait as well, and they're likely to be delighted to see that their sons and daughters are as determined as they are.

Practical Parent versus Theoretical Child

On the other hand, the core engines that drive this kind of exploration and curiosity are completely different in Adventurers and Analysts. Adventurers usually enjoy exploring things simply because they present

a challenge, and then either move on to something more interesting or choose to spend time honing their skills in that particular area. Like other Explorers, Adventurers focus on the tangible and the real.

In contrast, Analysts are concerned less about the practical application of something and more about why something works the way it does from an intellectual perspective. They want to understand the hidden principles, systems, and patterns behind things, even when this knowledge offers few tangible benefits.

Consequently, Analyst children may not hesitate to question their Adventurer parents' suggestions or assumptions, not necessarily because they don't trust them but often because they're interested in why their parents believe they're right. However, such questions may also frustrate Adventurers, who may likely see them as a waste of time, and wonder why their kids just don't give something a try or focus on experimenting instead. Analyst children may not be persuaded by statements such as, "because it works," or, "this is the best way."

Finding Shared Interests

Analyst children are unlikely to require much emotional support, which can seem rather strange to kind, sensitive Adventurers. Analysts tend to be more self-sufficient than Feeling types – although this may cause problems when there's a genuine need to open up and discuss something, instead of hiding and rationalizing one's feelings. Adventurers, however, can certainly appreciate their Analyst children's need for independence and can be supportive of their desire for rational communication over emotional interactions. That being said, they'll likely need to find other ways to promote bonding with their Analyst kids.

More often than not, Adventurer parents bond with their Analyst children through shared activities and hobbies rather than heartfelt discussions about principles and values. It may be a good idea for these parents to make conscious efforts to encourage their daughters and sons to partake in something they're doing, developing mutual appreciation and understanding in this way.

Adventurer Parent and a Diplomat Child

An Inquisitive and Creative Combination

Even though Adventurers and Diplomats are complete opposites on many fronts, there is also some overlap among their traits. To begin with, Diplomat children are likely to be quite inquisitive and willing to explore new things. This inborn desire for freedom and creativity is likely to delight their Adventurer parents as well.

Adventurers tend to have an excellent grasp of reality, impressive practical skills, and the ability to focus completely on what's in front of them, immersing themselves fully in the present moment. However, Adventurer parents must remember that Diplomat children may have difficulties recognizing and understanding such traits due to their detachment from the practical world.

It's likely that Diplomat kids can always find something to focus on, even without their Adventurer parents' help. This is likely to delight Adventurers – however, parents with this personality type should ensure that their children have enough mental stimulation when it comes to available activities. Diplomats are idealistic and even somewhat poetic individuals, and these characteristics may baffle their practical and realistic Adventurer parents.

To give an example, these parents may see planting trees as a fun physical exercise, but their Diplomat children may start pondering what would happen if everyone in their city did the same – and then cheerfully present that idea to them.

Impulsive versus Idealistic

Just like Adventurers, Diplomat children are also likely to understand the importance of personal responsibility and the need to be able to make their own decisions. However, Adventurer parents shouldn't confuse this with their own tendency to experiment and push limits – Diplomats seek to develop strong inner principles and tend to pick noble, often too idealistic goals. These children may respond better to arguments based on values and principles than rewards and practical benefits.

This particular aspect is likely to be responsible for most of the tension between Adventurer parents and their Diplomat sons and daughters. Like other Explorers, Adventurers tend to be very selective about what interests them and have little patience for things that don't fall into that category – Diplomats prefer to dive deep and try to find something fascinating in everything they encounter, even when this promises few tangible rewards. Adventurer parents may need to at least pretend to be interested in their children's musings, or find activities that combine opportunities for personal growth with real-world experiences.

Accepting and Encouraging Differences

Adventurer parents should bear in mind that their Diplomat children require a completely different approach compared to what is natural for them, and they shouldn't attempt to "fix" their children's idealism or occasional naiveté. Rather, Adventurer parents should try to appreciate (and learn from) their kids' enthusiasm, open-mindedness, and creativity. Diplomats' abilities are often underappreciated and rejected as offering little practical value, so a little encouragement can go a long way.

Such issues are even more important during the teenage years. Thankfully, being nonconformists themselves, it's unlikely that Adventurer parents would be critical of their Diplomat teens' habits or push them to look for more conventional career paths. Instead, they're likely to encourage their Diplomat children to pursue something that inspires and motivates them and then help them along the way.

Adventurer Parent and a Sentinel Child

A Practical and Perceptive Pair

Adventurers share the Observant trait with their Sentinel children, which means that communication is likely to be relatively uncomplicated between them. Both types focus on practicality and facts, preferring to leave theoretical and abstract conversations to the Intuitive Analysts and Diplomats. Expectations tend to be straightforward, and Sentinel children always know exactly where they stand with their Adventurer parents.

The Observant trait also effects how these types experience their environment, and both Adventurer parents and Sentinel children are perceptive and focus on what's happening around them in the moment. Adventurers notice even subtle changes in their children's behavior, allowing them to respond quickly and efficiently to prevent situations from escalating to an unmanageable level.

This perceptiveness also promotes connection between parents and their sons and daughters – which is especially powerful for Adventurers who, as a Feeling type themselves, are very sensitive and caring individuals.

Not Enough Structure

Sentinel kids are likely to be very dutiful and obedient, trying very hard to meet their parents' expectations. They respect family hierarchy and traditional roles and expect their parents to set up clearly structured environments with well-defined rules. Sentinels don't like to find out what's acceptable through trial and error the way Adventurers do – they prefer to have a clear and upfront understanding of what's okay and what isn't. Although this is rarely the main goal of freedom-minded

Adventurers, parents with this personality type are likely to appreciate their Sentinel children's willingness to cooperate and listen to what they have to say.

Additionally, Sentinel children seek a safe and stable atmosphere above all else – spontaneity and fun come after these needs have been met. Adventurers should recognize these different needs and remember that their Sentinel daughters or sons are likely to be far more careful, traditional, and methodical in their exploration of the world. Children of this type are far more structure-seeking than Adventurers, and the latter's somewhat laissez-faire approach to parenting may not be ideal in such circumstances.

Respecting the Need for Stability

Sentinel children, and young children in general, need stability in order to build trusting relationships with their parents. Sentinels desire dependability and structure more than any other personality type, and they'll certainly struggle to connect with parents who don't provide such environments for them. Although they thrive on adventure and spontaneity, Adventurer parents need to modify their behavior to best meet the needs of their children, especially in their early years. From keeping a consistent feeding schedule to creating a bedtime routine, Adventurers can create the sense of security and dependability that their Sentinel children truly crave.

It's also important for Adventurers to respect their kids' aversion to risk-taking. Sentinels aren't the thrill-seeking type – making them less likely to be interested in riding a roller coaster or trying new foods. And, although they certainly benefit from moving outside of their comfort zone every so often, it's important to do this slowly and with their approval – breaking Sentinel children's trust is one of the most harmful mistakes parents can make.

Start by adding some new spices to the food they already like rather than forcing them to try a completely foreign dish. Take them for a spin on the carousel and then gradually introduce them to more intense rides. Adventurers may find that Sentinel children who trust them and are allowed to take their time when trying new things are much more willing partners for future adventures.

Adventurer Parent and an Explorer Child

An Adventurous and Independent Team

Naturally, Adventurer parents find it easiest to communicate with their children if they belong to one of the Explorer types. Explorer children tend to be very adventurous and practical, often able to come up with exciting activities on their own as long as they're encouraged and given enough freedom to express themselves. Adventurer parents are likely to be fascinated by their children's curiosity, finding it easy to relate to and communicate with them.

Furthermore, Explorer children tend to feel very in tune with the present moment and the world around them, often enjoying sports and nature, even from a very young age. Nature-related activities are likely to form a large part of Adventurer parents' repertoire.

Like Adventurers themselves, Explorer kids are likely to place a lot of importance on freedom and independence, often insisting on being allowed to experiment and do things in their own way. Adventurers tend to cherish the idea of seeing their curious and enthusiastic children discover something new or exhaust themselves while spending hours on recently acquired hobbies.

That being said, such an improvisational and hands-off attitude is a double-edged sword. Knowing that their children love freedom of action, Adventurers may be reluctant to discipline them for overstepping their boundaries with all those experiments or to be firm in telling their sons and daughters that playtime is over and they should get back to studying.

Missing the Bigger Picture

Tangentially, Adventurer parents may also have difficulties teaching their Explorer children to find time for introspection and personal development. All Explorers are far more interested in real, palpable matters than internal discussions or abstract ideas, but both approaches have valuable things to offer. It's way too easy to forget to find time to stop and think about the direction their lives are going if they live mostly in the present.

Finally, as Adventurer parents focus more on improvisation and thinking on their feet, they tend to have difficulties with purely administrative and practical tasks. When unbalanced, this tendency can lead to serious issues in the future, especially in areas such as finance. Their Explorer children are likely to share this particular weakness, which is why parents with this personality type should make conscious efforts to teach their kids the importance of being economical, able to make fact-based decisions, and of knowing how to combine that restless curiosity with practical needs and responsibilities.

Considering the Future

As pleasant as it can be to live in the present moment, Adventurers may do their Explorer children a disservice by neglecting to consider the future. Encouraging their Explorer daughters and sons to view life as an adventure seems harmless enough, but children who lack direction or the ability to form well-thought-out plans can venture into some unsavory situations.

Going to college with absolutely no direction, for example, can result in some hearty student loans with no degree to show for it. Buying their first car without budgeting for payments, insurance, or fuel can result in a repossessed vehicle and a badly damaged credit score.

In order to prevent these potentially long-term issues, Adventurer parents should be intentional about helping their children to understand how their present actions affect their future. Children of all ages (even adolescents) aren't cognitively capable of fully understanding the potential consequences of their behaviors, so it's their parents' job to help them until they develop these abilities.

As impulsive individuals themselves, Adventurers may need to explore how their lack of planning or direction have affected their lives. Anecdotes about poor decisions they made as kids ("I decided to try some beer at a friend's party my sophomore year in high school.") and the negative outcomes that resulted ("I got really sick, and my parents grounded me for two months when they found out.") can help to illustrate the importance of considering future consequences.

Conclusion

Balancing their refreshing spontaneity and somewhat laissez-faire attitude with the responsibilities that come with parenthood can be challenging for Adventurer parents. But if they master the right approach, they not only raise children who are capable and responsible but also manage to build in an element of whimsy and adventure. It doesn't matter what personality type their children turn out to be. Smart discipline and the teaching of responsibility paired with Adventurers' unique personality style can help all children experience the best of both worlds.

Responsible parents always adapt themselves, regardless of their own core inclinations, to raise their children compassionately and intelligently. If Adventurers see parenting as a skill to acquire and try to do so, they're likely to be marvelous, conscientious parents who open unique doors in sometimes unconventional ways.

Final Words

Independently Passionate

Creative and even artistic, Adventurers seek to apply a fresh spin to whatever it is they're passionate about, and this often includes their relationships. For them, each moment is an exciting opportunity to create something new – which overwhelmingly provides the wind in the sails of their most intimate connections.

While they are kind and sensitive to the needs of both their family and friends, Adventurers are still Introverts, and they often need solitary time to recharge and regroup. Combine this tendency with their natural spontaneity and sometimes quirky take on things, and it's easy to see how Adventurers might come across as unpredictable and unconventional to some. They may have an air of being flighty or impulsive, which is just another way to interpret their simultaneously imaginative and independent nature.

One of the major challenges that Adventurers face is locating that middle ground between respecting the needs of their partners, friends, and children and finding ways to be true to themselves. Fortunately, Adventurers are well equipped with the clever creativity that's often needed to find and maintain this balance in their relationships.

So... What's Next?

You've reached the end of this book, but fear not – we've created many more resources for you. Here are a few that might capture your interest:

- Want more tests and insights to help you better understand and strengthen your relationships? Explore our Relationships Specialized Tests.
- Looking to enhance your academic or professional life? Check out the *Adventurer Guide to Careers*.
- Ready to build a strong foundation for your self-development? Our *Adventurer Guide to Personal Growth* may be just what you need.

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